



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Communication at work is important!



Learning Outcome

Relate information about common solutions to problems in spoken or written documents.

Ask your partner:

- When you have a big problem at work, who do you talk to about it? Why?
- What are the qualities of a good boss?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about reactions and behavior in a work situation.
- I can ask for clarification and confirmation.
- I can shift emphasis by using *what*, *who*, or *that*.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa suggests that Sally speak to **Human Resources***.

* "Human Resources" is the department in a company that deals with hiring and training employees.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** Wow, Sally, you look drained. You're stressed out, aren't you?
- Sally:** Yeah. What I really need is a vacation!
- Vanessa:** What's going on? You aren't still rattled about what happened yesterday with your boss, are you?
- Sally:** A little. It really threw me for a loop.
- Vanessa:** You're really sensitive, aren't you? Listen, what you need to do is talk to your boss about it. You need to have really open communication so that there are no misunderstandings. Make sure you ask lots of questions and be sure that other people understand you, too.
- Sally:** You're right. What I should do is schedule a meeting with my boss so we can discuss the variances in our communication styles.
- Vanessa:** Good idea! You need to have a face-to-face conversation, don't you? That you haven't spoken frankly with her yet is surprising.
- Sally:** To be honest, I'm a little fearful of talking to her. She's really menacing sometimes.
- Vanessa:** Menacing! That's not right! Who you should really talk to is someone in human resources. Your boss is fairly new, isn't she? Maybe she needs some guidance on how to deal with her employees.
- Sally:** Okay. Tomorrow I'm going to meet with her and address the communication issues we have. If she's not open to discussing this with me, then I'll ask to speak to someone in human resources about her behavior.
- Vanessa:** Sounds like a good plan. Good luck!





Let's Practice!

Vanessa and Sally emphasize what is important

Instructions: Complete the text by choosing from the words you are given. Use capital letters where necessary.

1. _____ I really need is a vacation!
(when / what / who / that)
2. _____ you haven't spoken frankly with her yet is surprising.
(when / that / what / who.)
3. Listen, _____ you need to do is talk to your boss about it.
(what / when / who / that)
4. _____ you really should talk to is someone in human resources.
(If / what / that / who)
5. _____ I should do is schedule a meeting with my boss.
(what / how / where / that)



Let's Practice!

Are you sure? Do you need confirmation? Let's practice using tag questions.

Instructions: Match the sentences on the left with their corresponding question tag.

- | | |
|--|----------------|
| 1. You aren't still rattled about what happened yesterday with your boss | a. are you? |
| 2. You're stressed out | b. don't you? |
| 3. Your boss is fairly new | c. isn't she? |
| 4. You need to have a face-to-face conversation | d. aren't you? |





Extension Activity

Tell a friend what they should have done.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Invent three things that happened to you or three mistakes that you made.
- Tell your partner the three things that happened to you and listen to his or her advice for what you should have done.
- Switch roles. Listen to what happened to your partner and give advice using *should have*, *could have* and *would have*.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about reactions and behavior in a work situation.

☐ ☐

I ask for clarification and confirmation.

☐ ☐

I shift emphasis by using *what*, *who*, or *that*.

☐ ☐

I give advice about what has happened.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **drained** (adjective): very tired
e.g. Wow, Sally, you look drained.
- **rattled** (adjective): worried or nervous
e.g. You aren't still rattled about what happened yesterday?
- **to throw someone for a loop** (expression): to confuse or surprise someone
e.g. It really threw me for a loop.
- **variance** (noun): an amount of difference or change
e.g. We can discuss the variances in our communication styles.
- **face-to-face** (adjective): in person; in the same location
e.g. You need to have a face-to-face conversation.
- **frankly** (adverb): in an honest and direct way
e.g. That you haven't spoken frankly with her yet is surprising.
- **fearful** (adjective): feeling fear
e.g. I'm a little fearful of talking to her.
- **menacing** (adjective): causing fear, or intimidation
e.g. She's really menacing sometimes.





Learning Points

Question Tags

When you want to make sure that something you've just said is true, or you seek agreement from the person you are speaking to, you can add short questions after your statement. These short questions are called question tags.

If what you said is in the affirmative form, the question tag will be in the negative form. Use this when you think the other person will agree by saying 'yes'.

- You **were** taken by surprise, **weren't** you?
- You **are** Canadian, **aren't** you?
- She **has** a brother, **doesn't** she?
- He **can** cook, **can't** he?

If what you said is in the negative form, the question tag will be in the affirmative form. Use this when you think the other person will agree by saying 'no'.

- You **weren't** taken by surprise, **were** you?
- You **aren't** Canadian, **are** you?
- She **doesn't** have a brother, **does** she?
- He **can't** cook, **can** he?

If the main verb is *to be* or a **modal** verb, the tag will be the same. For all other main verbs, use the tag *do/does* or *did/didn't*.

Look at the examples in the chart:

Main Verb	Tag	Main Verb	Tag
He is/was	isn't/was't he?	She has/had	doesn't/didn't she?
You are	aren't you?	You have	don't you?
He can	can't he?	He likes	doesn't he?
We could	couldn't we?	You like	don't you?
You will	won't you?	You liked	didn't you?

Examples:

- You're stressed out, aren't you?
- You aren't still rattled about what happened yesterday with your boss, are you?





Learning Points

- *You really are sensitive, aren't you?*
- *You need to have a face-to-face conversation, don't you?*
- *Your boss is fairly new, isn't she?*

What Clauses and Long Noun Phrases as Subjects

You can use "What-clauses" and "long noun phrases" as the subjects of long sentences.

When we usually write or say something in English we usually bring focus to the subject rather than the action. Look at the following:

Example: John told a funny joke.

If you instead want to shift focus from the subject to the action you can restate the same information in the following manner:

Example: What John said was funny.

By using "What" at the beginning of the sentence we have effectively shifted emphasis from the subject to the action undertaken.

Another way of shifting the focus from the subject to the action is to use "That" or "Who" in a similar way.

Example: That John imitated our teacher was really funny.

Example: Who he should have made fun of was the principal.

Examples:

- *What I really need is a vacation!*
- *What you need to do is talk to your boss about it.*
- *What I should do is schedule a meeting with my boss.*
- *That you haven't spoken frankly with her yet is surprising.*
- *Who you really should talk to is someone in human resources.*

